

Checklist

For Song Accompaniment on the Harp



Get Your Key Singature

- What key suits your vocal range?
- Do you need to raise/lower any levers to put yourself in a new key? (All levers down is key of C. F levers up is key of G. F+C levers up is key of D etc.)



Get Your Time Signature

- How many beats are per bar?
- Can you clap along to a beat of 3? Or 4?
- 3/4 and 4/4 time are the most common; they tell you how many beats are per bar.



Choose Your Chords

- In any key, you have 7 basic chords to choose from. In the key of C, these are:

	C	Dm	Em	F	G	Am	Bdim
	↓	↓	↓	↓	↓	↓	↓
with fingers:	$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} G \\ F \\ D \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} B \\ G \\ E \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} C \\ A \\ F \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} D \\ B \\ G \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} E \\ C \\ A \end{bmatrix}$	$\begin{bmatrix} F \\ D \\ B \end{bmatrix}$

This is your basic triad shape:

- Use a triad shape, 5th or an octave. (A 5th would be like any of the chords above without the middle note and just using fingers 3 & 1. An octave uses fingers 4 & 1 and plays from say a low C to a high C or a low D to a high D; they are the always the same notes, just one octave apart)

- Figure out what chord sounds good with each line of your song, Google it or take time to train your ear. You can try moving up the scale in a triad shape until you find what sounds good.



Choose Your Pattern

- Now we can choose how to play those chords, rhythmically and harmonically. Patterns are what add character to your accompaniment. Will you play the left hand and right hand together in a block chord (playing all the notes at the same time) or will you separate them into broken chords (playing from the bottom to the top, each note separately)?
- Will you play your chords in triads or 5ths? Maybe you'll do an octave in the left hand and a triad in the right? Both hands in broken triads? Or a single note in the left hand and a 5th in the right?

- Think about the rhythm of your piece. If you know you want to play a C chord with a certain line and you're in 4/4 time, maybe you'll do a chord in the left hand for beat 1 and three chords in the right hand for beats 2, 3 & 4? So Left-Right-Right-Right for beats 1, 2, 3, 4. Or you could do Left-Right-Left-Right for 1, 2, 3, 4?